

News Weekly

U.S. Coast Guard searches for missing vessel offshore Saipan

The U.S. Coast Guard is searching for a missing cargo vessel that experienced engine failure near Saipan on Wednesday. Watchstanders at the Joint Rescue Coordination Center Honolulu received a report from the vessel manager of the Mariana, a 145-foot U.S.-registered dry cargo vessel, indicating the starboard engine was disabled with six people aboard about 140 miles north-northwest of Saipan. The Coast Guard set up hourly communication with the Mariana via the vessel manager, with no medical concerns reported. Communication was lost Wednesday evening and hasn't been re-established. A Coast Guard HC-130 Hercules plane began searching Thursday but returned to Guam due to heavy winds. Another search is planned for Saturday morning. The last known position of the Mariana is approximately 140 miles north of Saipan. Anyone with helpful information should contact the Coast Guard on VHF-FM channel 16 or call the Joint Rescue Coordination Center Honolulu at 1-800-331-6176. (Source: Coastguard news)



Scientists revive ancient 24,000-year-old 'zombie worm' from Arctic ice

Scientists have successfully revived a 24,000-year-old microscopic organism from Siberian permafrost, offering new insight into how life can endure extreme conditions over vast stretches of time.

According to a study published in the journal *Current Biology*, researchers identified the organism as a rotifer — a tiny, multicellular animal often found in freshwater environments and known for its unusual durability.

The specimen had been frozen deep within Siberian permafrost since the Late Pleistocene, a period that ended roughly 11,700 years ago. Scientists say the surrounding ice-rich soil, known as the Yedoma formation, helped preserve the organism in a stable, frozen state for tens of thousands of years.

After carefully thawing the rotifer under controlled laboratory conditions, researchers observed that it resumed normal biological functions. The organism not only became active again but was also able to reproduce asexually, suggesting that its cellular structures remained intact despite the passage of millennia. (Source: Fox news)



61-year old Venezuelan immigrant scammed by fake law firm

Odalys González Silvera, a 61-year-old Venezuelan immigrant residing in New York, became a victim of immigration fraud while seeking legal assistance for a family member in detention. After an unsuccessful engagement with a lawyer in Arizona, she reached out to a Facebook account masquerading as a law firm. An individual claiming to be attorney Enrique De Jesus Duarte assured her of prompt assistance. González Silvera was deceived by convincing documentation and video calls, ultimately realizing she had been scammed. Legal experts indicate that such fraudulent schemes have proliferated in the context of escalating immigration challenges. The Facebook account is now inactive, and attempts to contact the purported law firm have proven unsuccessful. Duarte, whose name was misappropriated, clarified that he does not handle immigration cases and expressed his concern regarding the identity theft. (Source: NBC)



Runaway kangaroo spotted on Texas highway

A coffee truck owner was in for a wild ride on a North Texas highway, and nope, it wasn't because of the caffeine! While twiddling thumbs waiting for a tow, Carlie Butler, the brains behind Espressoak from Abilene, spotted the most unexpected road companion—a kangaroo!

Here's the scoop: Carlie was marooned on Interstate 20 after a tire decided to call it quits near Gordon. Hours crawled by when, boing, along came a hopping marsupial to keep her company.

Carlie quipped to Storyful, "Years of hustling as a small biz owner and who knew all it took to go viral was a breakdown and a kangaroo cameo?" The unexpected visitor spread smiles and spotlight at just the right time. Carlie's coffee trailer is getting a makeover, and she's brewing up plans to bounce back in a couple of weeks.

The mystery? Where in the world did that kangaroo come from? Turns out, owning kangaroos in Texas is a-okay, so the hopping tale continues! (Source: Fox)



"Golden orb" finally identified as part of an anemone

The mystery surrounding the enigmatic "golden orb," which was discovered during a NOAA expedition in the Gulf of Alaska in 2023, has now been thoroughly elucidated. This intriguing orb, found at a remarkable depth of 3,250 meters, puzzled scientists and researchers for more than two years. Initial hypotheses regarding its nature were quite varied, with some suggesting it might be an egg case, while others speculated it could be a deceased sponge. However, after an extensive period of comprehensive research and analysis conducted by NOAA Fisheries in collaboration with the Smithsonian National Museum of Natural History, it was conclusively determined that the orb is actually a remnant of dead cells from the base of the giant deep-sea anemone, *Relicanthus daphneae*. This particular species is known for attaching itself to rocky substrates, which accounts for the orb's distinctive and unusual appearance. The investigation into its identity utilized an integrative taxonomic approach, incorporating both morphological and genetic analyses. Although the initial DNA barcoding efforts yielded inconclusive results, whole-genome sequencing eventually confirmed the orb's identity, firmly establishing its genetic relationship with the known species of the anemone. (NOAA)



Wordle



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Creamy Mushroom Pasta

Ingredients

- ☐ 160g/ 6oz fettuccine or linguine (Note 1)
- ☐ 2 tbsp (30g) unsalted butter
- ☐ 1/2 tbsp olive oil (Note 2)
- ☐ 300g/ 10 oz mushrooms , sliced 1/3 cm / 1/8" thick (white, cremini/swiss brown)
- ☐ 2 garlic cloves , finely chopped
- ☐ 1/2 cup (125 ml) white wine , dry (or rose, sub more broth)
- ☐ 1/2 cup (125ml) chicken broth/stock , low sodium (or veg)
- ☐ 3/4 cup (185ml) cream , heavy / thickened (Note 3)
- ☐ 1/3 cup (30g) parmesan , finely grated (Note 4)
- ☐ 1/2 tsp salt and pepper , each

SERVING:

- ☐ Extra parmesan , for serving
- ☐ Parsley , roughly chopped (optional)

Recipe Notes:

- Pasta – flat wide pastas are best for creamy sauces like this but any pasta will work just fine, short, long, normal or fancy. Use dried not fresh pasta.
- Oil + butter – using combo prevents butter burning and makes it easier to make mushrooms golden.
- Cream – recipe will work with light, but obviously lacks the same amount of richness! ? Toss pasta at end with splash of pasta cooking water – the extra starch in the water will help make the sauce thick like using full fat cream.
- Parmesan – either finely grate your own, or buy the finely shredded parmesan at the shops (ie the short very thin strands) Do not use store bought sandy parmesan or shaved, they will not melt.
- Leftovers – keeps better than most creamy pastas I share because I use a bit more cream in this recipe than I usually do! Fridge for 3 days or so, then reheating the microwave. Add a tiny splash of water to loosen up the sauce if needed.

Instructions

- Cook pasta in salted water for 1 minute less than time per packet (start this mid mushroom cook). Just before draining, scoop out 1 cup cooking water, then drain.
- Melt butter and heat oil in a large skillet over high heat.
- Add mushrooms and cook, stirring regularly. When they start to sweat, add a pinch of salt and pepper.
- When pretty golden (about 4 – 5 minutes), add garlic and cook until garlic is golden and mushroom is golden.
- Stand back and add wine (it will be steamy!!), stir, scraping the bottom of the skillet. Simmer rapidly until wine is mostly evaporated and winy smell is gone.
- Add broth, cream, parmesan, salt and pepper. Stir to dissolve parmesan and simmer for 2 minutes, stirring regularly.
- Transfer pasta into sauce, toss for 1 – 2 minutes until sauce thickens and coats pasta. If sauce gets too thick (rather than slick, see video), add a splash of reserved pasta cooking water.
- Garnish with parsley and serve immediately with extra parmesan!

